



MONTHLY UPDATE

Liberia: monthly update, July – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-25 • 40 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH • GOVERNANCE • FINANCE • ICT INFRASTRUCTURE • DPI • TECHNOLOGY • CAPACITY • INCLUSION • DATA

Summary of the month

July 2026 was organised around the Liberia Technology Summit of 21-22 July, at which the President made the whole-of-government digital office the centre of the agenda and the telecoms ministry named four builds — a national digital addressing system, a second subsea cable, expanded fibre and a national data centre — none of them dated or costed. In the same weeks the telecoms regulator revoked an operator's licence, refused to publish its own revenue and became the subject of a corruption complaint; the African Development Bank launched a six-year country strategy with no digital sector in it; and the first figures were published for the e-procurement platform and the interoperable payment fee schedule.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

The African Development Bank launched its [country strategy for 2026-2031 in Monrovia on 30 July](#), cutting its sectors from four to three and funding an indicative 2026-2028 programme of UA 129m — US\$172.86m at the [February 2026 conversion — of which 36.3% is unfunded](#). The only digital line in the indicative programme is a non-lending study on digital solutions for Monrovia traffic congestion, and the strategy's own ICT assessment cites a policy that expired in 2024.

Legislation and regulation

The same package, [set out on 17 July](#), covers a split of infrastructure and service licences with rural incentives, tower-sharing rules, the country's first satellite regulations, an IMEI anti-theft regime and repatriation of the .lr country domain. None has been published as an instrument.

One piece of it is now a signed instrument. The regulator [signed satellite communications guidelines on 19 August](#), after a consultation that ran from February to June, and the text sets five-year non-geostationary and ten-year geostationary landing rights, a US\$250,000 direct-to-device service-provider licence fee with 9% of direct-to-device sales and a 0.5% universal-access contribution, mandatory data-protection and cybersecurity compliance plans, and a [twelve-month transition for operators already here](#). No licence has yet been issued under it on the record.

Data protection

The telecoms regulator [fined an operator LRD 4m for issuing a subscriber's SIM to a third party without authorisation](#). The penalty came under telecoms powers rather than data-protection law – which is the point, since the Act that would have supplied the latter is unsigned.

Regional collaboration

At the African Telecommunications Union plenipotentiary session in Abuja in July, Liberia [negotiated a waiver of US\\$361,151.36 in arrears dating back to 1982, deposited its instrument of ratification and had its voting rights restored](#).

Public debate and participation in policymaking

On 30 July the Anti-Corruption Commission [confirmed it had forwarded a complaint about the telecoms traffic-monitoring arrangement to its investigation unit](#). No evidence has been publicly produced and no findings made.

The month's one channel built to hear from the public rather than about it was relaunched by donors. UNICEF and UNFPA [relaunched the U-Report youth feedback platform on 13 August](#), with Irish embassy support and under a joint programme with the government, giving young people an encrypted SMS channel to answer polls on health, water and sanitation and other social issues, with responses analysable by county and a target of at least 8,000 reporters. The channel runs on one operator's SIM cards, which bounds who can take part.

Finance

New investments

The finance minister put the youth entrepreneurship investment bank at [almost US\\$18m targeting 30,000 youth-led businesses and about 100,000 jobs](#), with a national coordinator recruited and a board being constituted. No disbursement is stated.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

The regulator revoked [Starcell International Liberia's universal licence and spectrum authorisation with immediate effect on 22 July 2026](#), after a 90-day suspension from 9 February during which no corrective action was taken; spectrum, numbering resources and regulatory privileges revert to the Authority. The grounds cited were failure to commence operations, unmet financial obligations and non-payment of universal access contributions.

At the same 21 July event, the Posts and Telecommunications Minister [announced a second subsea cable and expanded fibre](#), with no completion date, budget line or cable landing partner given for either; the LTA separately said it is reviewing a World Bank-supported report on reducing telecom costs.

The Anti-Corruption Commission's 30 July complaint over the telecoms traffic-monitoring arrangement, forwarded to its investigation unit, is covered under Governance and regulation → Public debate and participation in policymaking below.

Data Storage

At the same 21 July event the minister also [announced a national data centre to hold government data domestically](#), with no completion date, budget line or site given.

Cybersecurity

The Cybercrime Act 2025 [had still not received presidential signature as of 1 July](#), nearly six months after the Senate's concurrence cleared its passage through the Legislature. The full text the base holds is the 2021 base bill, which carries none of the 2025 provisions.

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

The identity build reached the legislature. The National Identification Registry says [procurement of an Austrian firm to build a new biometric identification system under a public-private partnership is complete, and the concession agreement is with the President ahead of legislative ratification](#); a day later, [consultations on the draft agreement had concluded and it had gone to Parliament for approval](#), with the registry stating it will disclose the terms only once ratification is complete and officials saying issuance will be free for poor first-time applicants. Mass enrolment has been suspended since 23 June 2025, so the country has been more than a year without one, and coverage stands [below 15% of a population above five million](#). No concession value, term, revenue model or data-protection provision is published.

A second identity register is being built outside the state entirely. On 16 August the commercial motorcycle and tricycle riders' union and a private digital services company [signed a memorandum to build a digital identity, GPS tracking and a rider database](#), aimed at curbing vehicle theft and linking informal-sector riders to formal financial and government services. It covers continuous location tracking of a working population, and no data-protection basis, custodian, retention rule or consent mechanism is reported for it.

Digital Payments and Fintech

The central bank's fee schedule for interoperable transfers was reported on 5 August: [1.0% of value from US\\$1.00 to US\\$2,000.00 and a flat US\\$25.00 above that, available 24 hours a day. The flat cap falls below 1.0% of value above about US\\$2,500](#) and keeps falling.

On 28 July the finance minister named the [national electronic payment switch as the enabler of a 24-hour economy, with creative-sector support to enter the 2027 budget](#). No go-live date was given.

The central bank also put on record how the system was built. Its own account is that it worked [to a business case rather than to a regulation and stood the system up in 73 days, sequencing government payments first - civil-servant salaries off cheques and into wallets, which gave the integrated mobile-money operators access to float](#), against a national target of half of adults holding a bank or wallet account.

Registries

Speaking on 21 July, the Posts and Telecommunications Minister said [rollout of a national digital postal address system had begun across all fifteen counties](#), with no completion date or budget line given.

The central bank is preparing a register of a different kind. It announced on 14 August that it is [extending the 2010 movable-assets collateral registry to cover immovable property such as land, buildings and fixed machinery](#), as part of a wider financial-sector reform. No launch date, registration volume, fee schedule or relationship to the land registry is stated.

Sectoral management information systems

The month's clearest finding about a government system is that it does not exist. The General Auditing Commission found that a [digital lending platform built for the World Bank and IFAD-backed STAR-P project was still undelivered, with US\\$36,768 paid in full to a savings and loans institution for a system contractually due live by May 2025 and not deployed at the auditor's May 2026 field verification](#). The same Management Letter, issued on 29 June 2026 for the audit period to 31 October 2025, found no functional project audit committee, a US\$27,000 consultancy let without competitive procurement, and an agriculture commercialisation fund's reporting dashboard never formally handed over to the ministry. The platform is now recorded as *Not held* with a dated search behind it.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The e-procurement platform published its first operating figures on 5 August: [more than 1,200 vendors registered and more than US\\$400,000 in revenue generated](#). No contract value transacted, tender count, bidder numbers or share of government procurement passing through the platform is given. Two days later it became an export: Sierra Leone's procurement authority [sent a delegation to Monrovia on 6-7 August to study the implementation](#), where the executive director dated the national launch to February 2025 after a six-institution pilot and credited the African Development Bank and the World Bank with the backing behind it. A later account of the same visit [records the telecommunications regulator receiving equipment to strengthen its own use of the platform](#), framed as deepening bilateral cooperation on digital transformation and procurement transparency.

Licensing moved off paper in the same week. The telecommunications regulator [put an automated telecom licensing and renewal platform into service](#), letting applicants apply and renew online while keeping in-person service available. No licence count, processing time or fee schedule is published.

A second permit process is following it online. The education ministry says it is [digitising operating permits for private schools after finding schools submitting mismatched teacher-qualification records, and has mapped schools across five counties with donor support to extend the mapping to ten more](#). No platform, cost or completion date is named.

Technology

AI

At the President's third national youth town hall in Buchanan on 29 July, the President's Youth Advisory Council called for artificial intelligence to be made a national priority through education frameworks, innovation and fabrication laboratories and skills provision. The President [did not dismiss it and conditioned support on applications in agriculture, transport and commerce; no policy, institution, budget line or date followed](#).

The country's first working legal AI was launched on 31 July: [CJ Lewis, built by the law library Liblaw over Supreme Court opinions from 1861 to 2026 plus statutes and regulations, with OHCHR support on human-rights principles in the design](#). No accuracy or evaluation figure is given, no model or vendor is named, and the corpus is a private compilation.

ICT Industry

The port authority signed a [non-exclusive smart-ports memorandum with HAROPA PORT covering all four seaports, with no amount, date or named system](#).

Innovation ecosystem

The technology summit closed on 22 July with a [Monrovia cybersecurity firm winning the national Startup World Cup on a domestic-data-custody pitch](#).

UNDP set out its contributions at the summit, adding in its own account of 3 August that its innovation hub sits under its Africa innovation platform.

Capacity

Literacy

On 31 July, 19 young leaders took the [first of three media and information literacy sessions in Monrovia](#), run through the UN electoral support project with the National Elections Commission and the Press Union on Canadian funding. Six external funders and implementers stand behind a programme whose stated purpose is national resilience against misinformation before elections, and no budget figure is disclosed for it.

Training and skills

UNDP also [announced a partnership with the University of Liberia to establish the country's first master's degree in artificial intelligence](#), with no commitment amount disclosed.

Inclusion

Access to services

No later figure for account ownership or mobile wallet holding has been published. The base's position rests on the [account of digital finance expansion of 13 July](#), which carries no measurement of its own.

Data

Open data

The telecoms regulator's chairman declined at a 30 July press briefing to disclose the Authority's revenue, [saying he reports to the President](#). The Authority publishes industry data — its 2025 mid-year report puts the two operators' combined revenue at US\$96.1m for the first half of 2025 against US\$79.8m a year earlier — but its own licensing fees, spectrum charges, levies and numbering receipts remain unpublished as at 4 August 2026.

Use of satellite data

The Land Authority took the country's geospatial ambition abroad rather than to a budget. At the United Nations' sixteenth global geospatial information management session in August it [sought international partnerships and technical support to build a National Spatial Data Infrastructure](#) — a coordinated geospatial framework for land administration, mapping and national planning. It is an approach for support rather than a programme: no funding, custodian, standard or timetable is stated, and the base still holds no earth-observation or geospatial data programme of any kind.

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